

Mitsue-Kanko (Forest Co-op) Meeting — 5 Aug 2026

Question list (Phase 0–1 only)

Source: `forest_group_discussion_topics.md` (full version)

Guiding principle (state first — not a question)

Purpose of replanting is ecosystem restoration (restore wildlife food supply), not short-term timber profit. More Trees is in charge of species selection (they have the expertise); co-op plants + tends.

Understand what they do today

- ☐ What forestry work do they currently do? (thinning, afforestation, processing, sales)
- ☐ Do they already have native broadleaf / Miyawaki-style reforestation expertise, or is their replanting experience sugi-only?
 - ☐ Experience with **local-provenance seedlings** (seed-collect + nursery in village, replant on same land)?
 - ☐ Experience with **assisted natural regeneration** (no planting — tend existing seedlings)?
 - ☐ Familiar with / tried **natural species arrangement** or Miyawaki dense planting?
- ☐ Co-op capacity: chippers, operators, crew availability?

Village government status (raised at More Trees' Kishi-san's request)

- ☐ **Does the village government already have its own reforestation/forest-use plan in motion that doesn't involve us or More Trees?**

More Trees' participation is contingent on village-government go-ahead — need to confirm there isn't an existing separate plan.

Checked council minutes archive (2017/18–2026, 100 files): no standalone reforestation plan found — only 森林環境譲与税-funded thinning administration and one private operator's small cherry-tree pilot in Kozue. Absence in the public record isn't confirmation; still ask directly.

Chip production (supply chain)

- ☐ Who does the thinning — co-op, private contractors, or hybrid?
- ☐ Equipment needed (own vs. rent vs. contract)?
- ☐ Can they meet the CHP's chip sizing standard (P31S / P45, ~30–50 mm)?
- ☐ Transport route from forest to processing/storage site?

Drying & storage

- ☐ Who dries the green chips?
- ☐ Location — co-located with CHP or a satellite forest site?
- ☐ Fire safety / permitting requirements for chip storage?

Role & relationship

- ☐ Role: partner, contractor, or hybrid?
- ☐ Willing to plant + tend native broadleaf (species selected by More Trees) for wildlife forage?
- ☐ Interested in co-running seedling/nursery work as a school or eco-tour programme?
- ☐ Profit-sharing or service-fee model?

Land & contracts

- ☐ Can they help inventory landowners for the parcels involved?
- ☐ Any village-owned forest land usable without private contracts?
- ☐ Would they support setting up a formal association (landowner liaison body) to manage contact and agreements between parcel landowners and Mitsue Kanko for this project?
- ☐ They're already the village's contractor for 施業放置林整備事業 (neglected-forest thinning, financed by 森林環境譲与税, run at a 40% thinning rate) — how much of their current crew/equipment capacity is absorbed by that work, and how much could be freed up or added for our reforestation work?
- ☐ Council record (Jan 2024) puts village-wide neglected forest (放置林) at ~2,600 ha — does that match their own internal figures, and is any of it already earmarked for our target areas?
- ☐ On recent clear-cut sites where there's no binding replanting requirement (village can only "encourage" it) — would they be open to a standing practice of native-broadleaf replanting on clear-cuts they handle, even without a legal mandate?

AI data center & biomass — the workforce pull (newly attracted crew)

Context: the CHP biomass fuel demand and the AI-data-center mission are the "pull" behind our workforce & relocation strategy ([mitsue_workforce_relocation_strategy.md](#)) to double/triple the co-op crew.

- ☐ Does the co-op see **year-round CHP fuel demand** (vs. seasonal thinning) as a basis for offering stable, full-time forestry jobs?
- ☐ Would a **guaranteed biomass chip offtake** (fixed volume + price) give them the confidence to hire and train new crew?
- ☐ How many additional crew could they realistically absorb and train per year?
- ☐ Openness to the energy project **funding mechanization** (harvesters, chippers) to raise per-worker output?
- ☐ Would they employ **relocated / newly-recruited workers** directly under the co-op, or prefer a joint arrangement / secondment?
- ☐ Does the "reforest → power AI compute → revive the village" mission story help *them* recruit and retain

(the known 3-year retention problem of relocation schemes)?

- ☐ Any concern that outside-funded growth changes the co-op's character or member control?

Precedent to cite: Tenkawa × more trees

Tenkawa Village + Dorogawa Property Ward (洞川財産区) signed a formal cooperation agreement with more trees on 2021-06-07 (Sakamoto Ryuichi himself), still active through 2025 — Kii Peninsula's first more trees village agreement. ~6 ha of clear-cut former ski-resort land replanted with native broadleaf (キハダ), 3,000+ trees over 3 years, funded by rotating corporate sponsors (UGG/Deckers Japan, 三井住友カード, 三井住友銀行, 株式会社ウォーターネット via the GFP carbon-offset scheme). Useful as concrete proof that this exact co-op-plants/NGO-funds model already works in a comparable Nara mountain village — worth mentioning if the co-op is skeptical of the arrangement.

Follow-up / next steps (after the meeting)

- If Kinjo agrees: fill in the Nara Forester Academy (奈良県フォレスターアカデミー) form, including Dome's reply/endorsement for the seminar request.
- Ask Kinjo whether she's willing to help with the NAIST presentation.

Related docs

- Full version: `forest_group_discussion_topics.md`
- Japanese: `meeting_mitsue_kanko_2026-08-05_jp.md`